

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 9 6 3

♥ A 6 4

♦ 8 6 3

♣ 8 2

♠ A 8 2

♥ 8 7 3

♦ K 9 2

♣ A 10 5 4



♠ 7 5

♥ J 10 5 2

♦ Q J 5 4

♣ K 6 3

♠ K 10 4

♥ K Q 9

♦ A 10 7

♣ Q J 9 7

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

3NT

1NT

All Pass

3NT by South

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 3NT

Lead the ♠ Q, the top of a broken honor sequence.

The top of a solid 3-card honor sequence is best, but as you can see, a broken 3-card sequence may work out just as good.

South will likely try the ♣ finesse, and when East wins the ♣ K he will return a ♠ through South's ♠ 10.

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 4 3
 ♥ 9 6 4
 ♦ A Q 10 8
 ♣ 9 8 3

♠ K J 7 2
 ♥ K J 10 3 2
 ♦ 7
 ♣ A 7 4



♠ 8 5
 ♥ A Q 8 5
 ♦ 5 4 3
 ♣ Q J 10 2

♠ A Q 10 6
 ♥ 7
 ♦ K J 9 6 2
 ♣ K 6 5

West	North	East	South
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Pass

1 ♥

Pass

1 ♦

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by South
 of trouble.

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 4 ♠

Lead any ♠.

You have ♦ winners, but dummy will surely be short since he has at least 8 cards in the Major suits.

Partner has whatever ♥ strength your side possesses.

It is very likely that declarer will want to do some cross-trumping. To try to cut that down your best lead is a trump.

Just imagine that declarer wins the first ♠ in his hand and plays a ♥ to dummy's honors. East will win and play another trump. Whenever you win your first ♦ you will play your last trump.

As you can imagine, declarer will be in a whole lot

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 9 4 3

♥ 6 5 3

♦ 8 2

♣ 10 6 2

♠ 8 7 2

♥ K 8 7

♦ K Q J

♣ A 8 5 4



♠ 10 5

♥ J 10 4 2

♦ 9 6 5 4 3

♣ J 9

♠ A Q 6

♥ A Q 9

♦ A 10 7

♣ K Q 7 3

West

North

East

South

Pass

6NT

2NT

All Pass

6NT by South

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 6NT

Lead the ♥6.

You held this identical hand in Deal 3. The declarer was playing 3NT and the best lead was the ♠4, fourth down.

It's different when the contract is 6NT. Against 6NT you should make a passive lead, which means don't underlead any honors. Against 6NT you have little chance of establishing a suit to win four or five tricks. Instead, you just want to try to not give declarer an undeserved trick.

So any passive lead would be OK, you pick the ♥ just because they are less likely to have an unbid 4-card Major in either hand.

Declarer has 11 winners sitting there; if you had led a low ♠ you would have handed him his 12 trick on a platter.

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 8 5 4

♥ 8 6 5 2

♦ K 6 2

♣ 10 2

♠ A 2

♥ A 9 7

♦ 10 5 3

♣ A K Q 7 6



♠ Q 9 7 6 3

♥ 10 4 3

♦ 4

♣ 9 8 4 3

♠ J 10

♥ K Q J

♦ A Q J 9 8 7

♣ J 5

West	North	East	South
			1 ♦
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	3 ♦
Pass	4NT	Pass	5 ♦
Pass	6 ♦		
All Pass			
6 ♦ by South			

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 6 ♦

Lead the ♠ 4.

Against a notrump slam it is best to make a passive lead so you don't give declarer an undeserved winner.

Against a suit slam the situation is very different. Against strong dummy bidding like this you are pretty sure that if you don't establish a winner early declarer will find something in dummy to discard losers on. In this hand it is dummy's ♣ suit.

Your most promising suit is ♠s. Obviously partner has a very weak hand, but if he has the ♠Q you can set up your ♠K before your King of trumps is dislodged.

Without a ♠ lead declarer will have smooth sailing.